Normalization

What's the big idea?

Normal form: Rules for which all schemas must follow.

Normalization: Process to put schemas in normal form.

Motivations:

- Objective criteria for a good design
- Fixing design mistakes
- Design from scratch (potentially, but not typical)

More specifically

Reduce redundancy!

On the other hand – Denormalization

We’ll later see that there are also benefits of not normalizing.

DB normal forms



- Domain/key
- 6th
- 5th = Project-join
- 4th
- Boyce-Codd = 3.5th
- 3rd
- 2nd
- 1st

Based on functional dependencies, i.e., what attributes depend upon.

Goal: Prevent DB anomalies.